

Daniel Okafor

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 8 years designing distributed backend systems that serve tens of millions of users. Led the platform migration that cut checkout latency 60% at a Fortune 500 retailer, and grew a 6-engineer team through two promotion cycles. Strong in Java, Go, and AWS.

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Go, Python, SQL, TypeScript

Distributed Systems: Kafka, gRPC, Kubernetes, Envoy, Cassandra, DynamoDB

Cloud & Platform: AWS (EKS, Aurora, SQS, CloudFront), Terraform, Helm, ArgoCD

Observability: Datadog, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana

Leadership: Technical design review, Mentorship, Incident command, Roadmapping

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Jan 2021 – Present

National Retail Platform

Seattle, WA

- Led a 6-engineer team migrating the monolithic checkout service to Kubernetes microservices, reducing p99 latency from 2.1s to 840ms across 30M monthly orders.
- Introduced an event-sourced inventory ledger on Kafka that eliminated oversell incidents, saving an estimated \$4.2M in annual chargebacks.
- Established the org-wide design review process now used by 40+ engineers, cutting post-launch rollback rate from 12% to 3%.
- Owned the 24/7 on-call rotation for tier-1 services and drove MTTR down from 47 minutes to 11 minutes.

Software Engineer

Aug 2017 – Dec 2020

Logistics SaaS Company

Portland, OR

- Designed a route optimization service in Go handling 500K daily shipments, improving on-time delivery 18%.
- Replaced nightly batch ETL with streaming ingestion, giving operations teams near real-time visibility instead of 12-hour-stale data.
- Cut CI pipeline duration from 38 minutes to 9 minutes by parallelizing test suites and caching build layers.

PROJECTS

Kafka Replay Toolkit | Go, Kafka, Docker

github.com/dokafor/kreplay

- CLI for deterministic replay of Kafka partitions during incident investigation; adopted internally by 4 teams.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Computer Science

University of Washington

Jun 2017

Seattle, WA

B.S. in Computer Engineering

Oregon State University

Jun 2015

Corvallis, OR

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator, CNCF (2022)